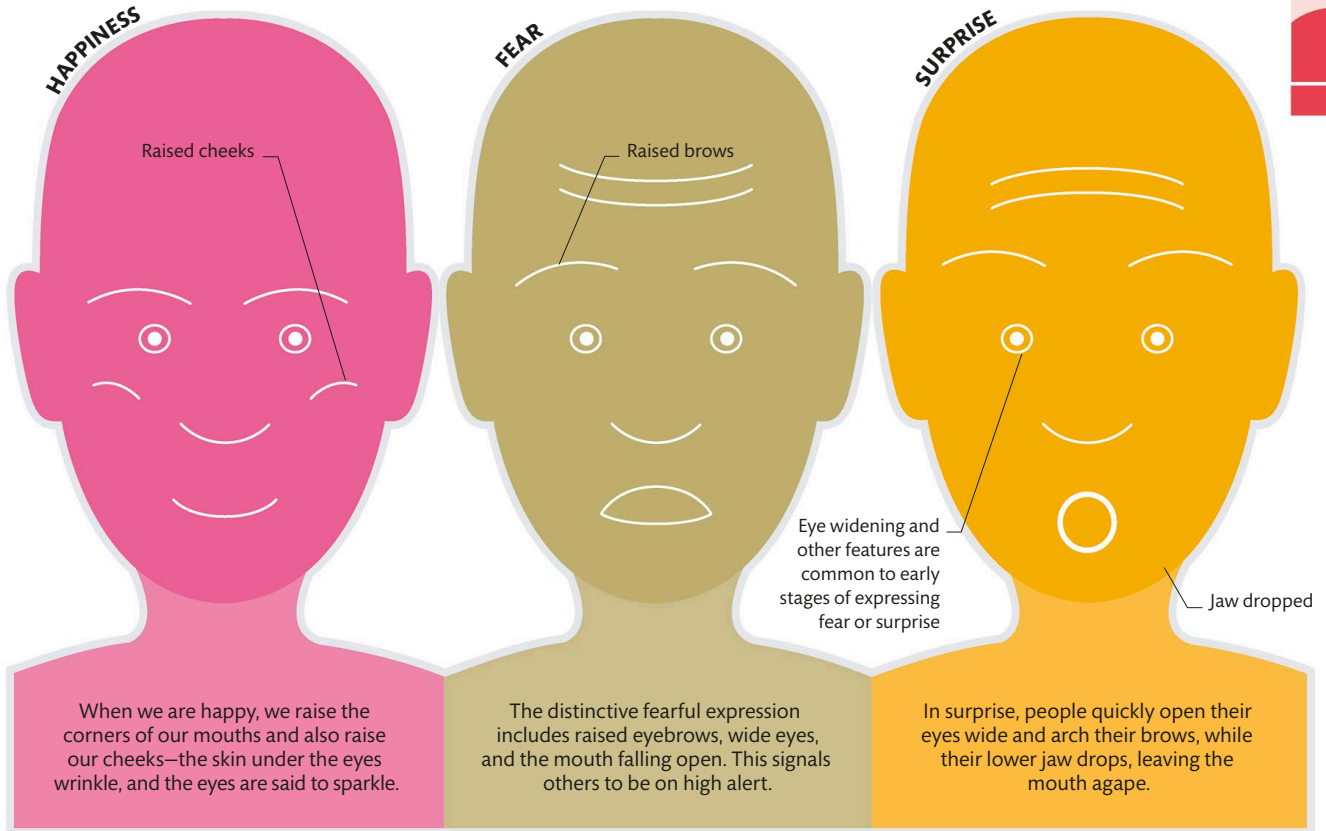
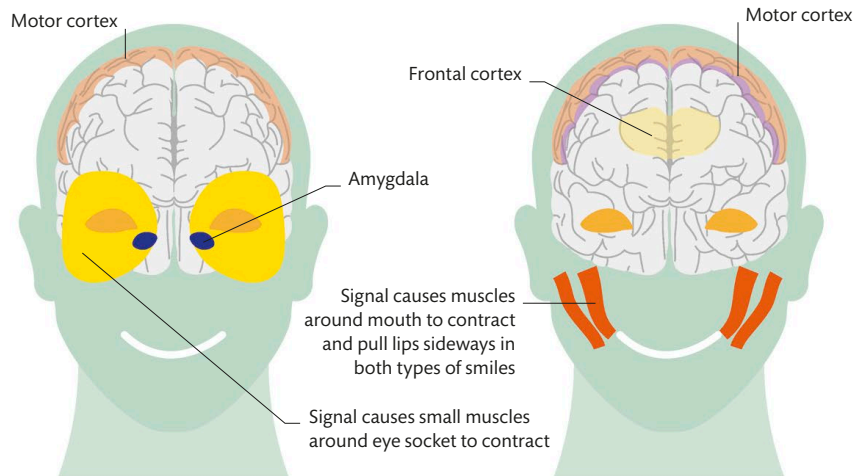




Smiling

A smile can either be a genuine expression of positive mood or a conscious, socially motivated action. Genuine smiles are unconscious acts that involve different muscle groups to social smiles. While both involve a stretched mouth with lips upturned at the corners, the genuine smiling person constricts muscles that raise the cheeks, producing “crow’s feet” around the eyes. Conscious smiles vary in their exact structure and are used in an array of social interactions—they can be socially bonding but also used to signal dominance, and people may also smile to mask embarrassment.



Genuine smile

The muscular contractions involved in genuine smiles are triggered by signals from the brain’s emotional centers, such as the amygdala, usually operating without our awareness.

Conscious smile

Conscious control of social smiling involves activation of the frontal cortex and signals from the motor cortex. The mouth muscles contract, but we can’t control the eye muscles.